

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's find out about a legendary environmental activist!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Who is your role model? Is it a celebrity, a sports person, a politician?
- In your opinion, which activist has made a big difference in our world? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can ask for help or advice.
- I can talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.

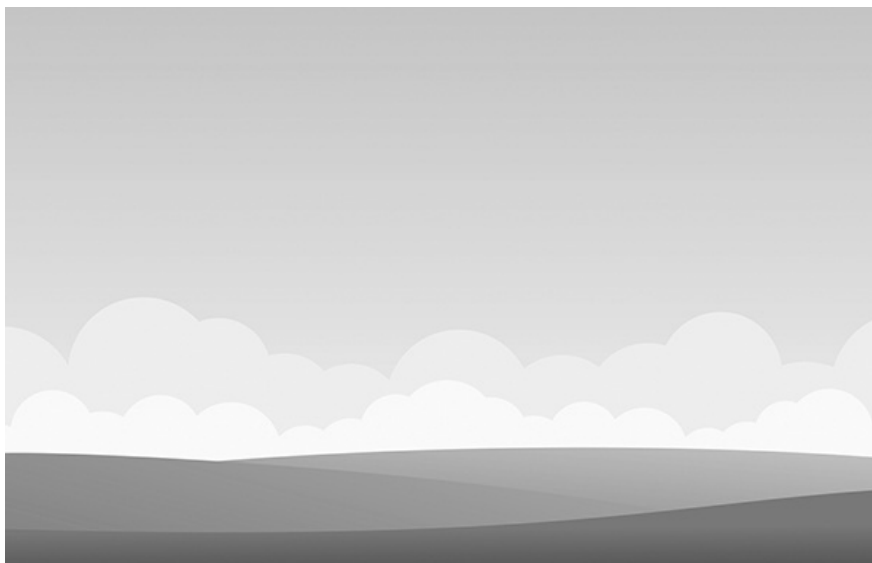




Let's Explore!

Sally finds out about an **exemplary*** activist.

* An "exemplary" person is someone whose life is an example to others.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** John, can you tell us who has inspired you as an environmentalist?
- John Smits:** I would say Rachel Carson. Seven years before she was born, her father bought land to the south of his home near Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. He thought that if the growing population spread onto his property, he would be able to make his fortune. He also believed that his daughter should have the opportunity to spend her childhood exploring untouched areas .
- Sally:** Could you explain to us why her life was so inspiring to you?
- John Smits:** The main factor that helped shape Carson's life was a love of both books and nature. Her mother believed that she could learn from her surroundings. If she looked close enough, she would understand how nature worked. Carson started to write about nature. She believed it would set her life on an environmental path.
- Sally:** Do you know how Rachel Carson gained universal appeal?
- John Smits:** After graduating, she worked as a marine biologist. She often wondered: "What should I do to get people committed to saving our waters? If I share my passion for the sea, people will take note!" This is why her first book, *Under the Sea Wind*, was welcomed with praise by both literary critics and scientists.





Let's Practice!

Sally asks John Smits about his inspiration as an environmentalist.

Instructions: Read the interview again. Read the question. Underline all the correct answers.

1. What did Sally ask John?

- Could you tell us who inspired you as an environmentalist?
- Can you tell us who has inspired you as an environmentalist?
- Could you explain to us why her life was so inspiring to you?
- Can you explain to us why her life was so inspiring to you?
- What should I do to get people committed to saving our waters?
- What should I do to try and help the environment?



Let's Practice!

If I lived in the country ...

Instructions: Choose words to correctly complete the sentences below.

1. If I lived in the country, I _____ be more concerned about the environment than I am now. **will / would / won't**
2. If I _____ live in the city, I would have a better understanding of how nature works. **didn't / hadn't / did**
3. If my father _____ me to the ocean every week, I would develop a love for the sea. **take / took / takes**
4. If I go to school during the summer, I _____ finish all my classes and be a marine biologist by next year. **shouldn't / won't / will**
5. If I studied more in science class, I _____ be so ignorant about how people affect nature. **wouldn't / would / won't**





Extension Activity

Give advice for problems.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write down two (or more) problems that the following types of people might have:
 - students
 - workers
 - the elderly
- Next, read the problems to a partner and ask for advice. Your partner should use modals to make suggestions in their answers.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I ask help for help or advice.

☐ ☐

I discuss how to deal with problems.

☐ ☐

I talk about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to spread** (verb): to extend over a large area
e.g. The population spread over Mr. Carson's empty land.
- **property** (noun): an area of land owned by someone
e.g. If the growing population spread onto his property, he would be able to make his fortune.
- **inspiring** (adjective): causing someone to feel creative; making them want to do something
e.g. Rachel Carson's life was inspiring to many environmentalists.
- **factor** (noun): a circumstance that contributes to an outcome
e.g. The main factor that helped shape Carson's life was a love of both books and nature.
- **universal** (adjective): affecting all people around the world
e.g. Carson gained universal appeal after she published her first book.
- **praise** (noun): strong approval and admiration for something or someone
e.g. Her first book, *Under the Sea Wind*, was welcomed with praise by both literary critics and scientists.





Learning Points

Modals for Suggestions

When you want to offer advice or give solutions to a problem, you use modals like *might*, *should* or *could*.

These modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "If ...".

The modal is followed by a verb in the base form. You do not use "to".

I would / I'd ...

I wouldn't ...

You could ...

You should ...

Examples:

- *Rachel Carson's father believed that his daughter should have the opportunity to explore untouched areas.*
- *Carson believed that writing about nature would set her life on an environmental path.*
- *What should I do to get people committed to saving our waters?*

Using How to / Where to / What to + Verb

When you want to request information, you can use the structures: How to / Where to / What to + Verb. These structures are a polite way of asking for someone to do something.

Example:

*Could you explain to people the steps on **how to write** a novel?*

*Can you tell us **what to do** if you want to be an environmentalist?*

These questions are often used in interviews. You ask this type of questions when you want to know more about a topic.

Can / Could / Do	you	verb	Structure	
Can	you	tell (me)	how to inspire	people to help the environment?
Could	you	explain	where to go	if you want to study marine biology?

